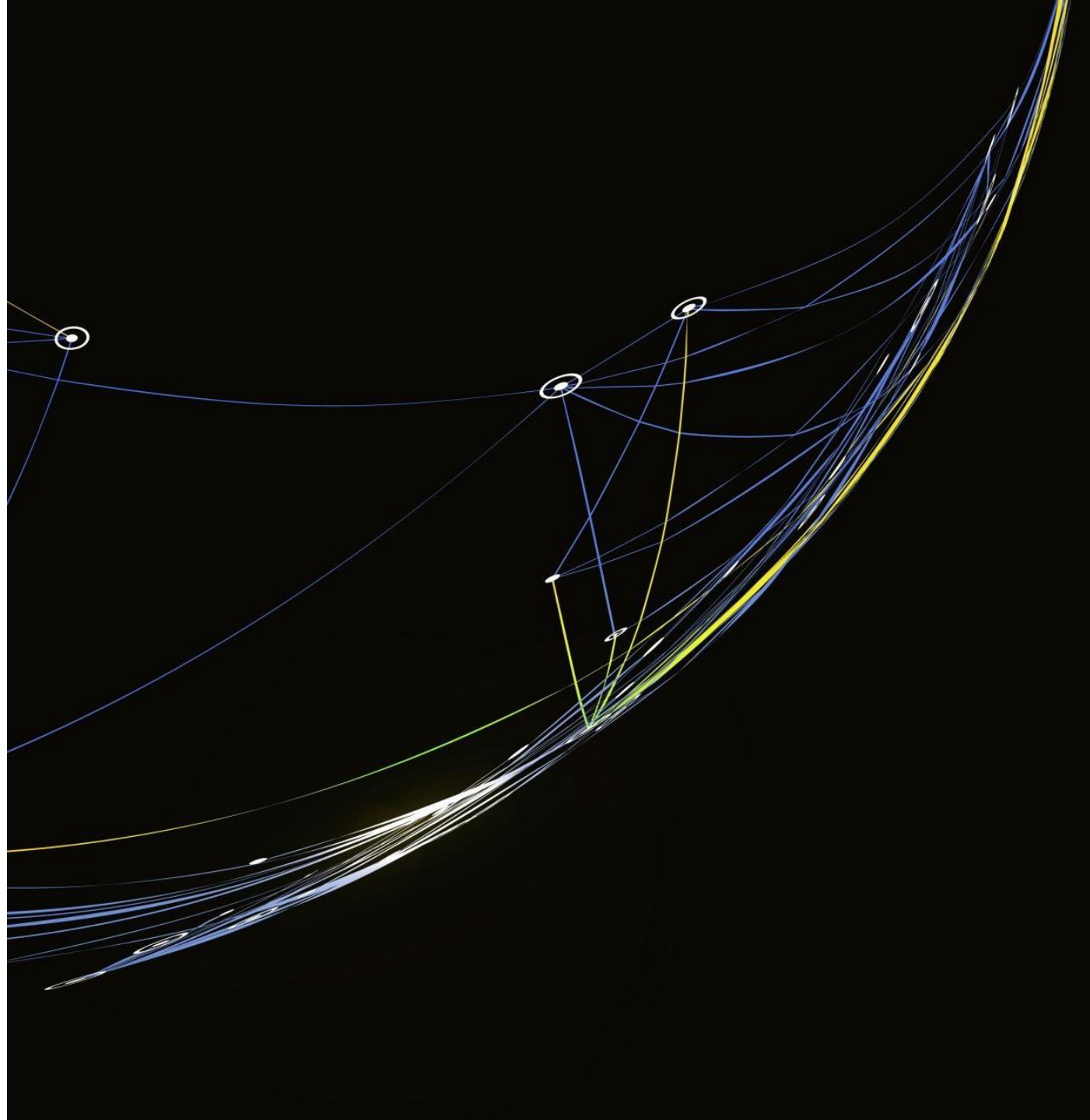


CFMA Strategic Pricing Recommendations

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FORDHAM UNIVERSITY, GABELLI SCHOOL OF
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Four moves

1. ***Index all non-dues pricing to inflation:*** Apply a CPI based annual increase across every non-dues product. Stop prices from falling behind.
2. ***Catch-up where prices are frozen:*** A one-time correction in prices where prices have been frozen for years.
3. ***Member vs non-member pricing:*** Widen member vs non-member pricing to make membership feel worth it.
4. ***Bundle Related Fees:*** Package fees into single, clear prices and a self-serve upgrade for the Benchmark.

Non-dues pricing has no consistent framework

CFMA generates about 60% of revenue outside membership dues. Dues rise every year with inflation. Non-dues pricing does not follow any comparable rule, and some prices have not moved in six or more years.

60%

of CFMA revenue comes from non-dues sources

6+ years

since Certification fees last moved

5

segments modeled, three pricing scenarios each

10+

peer associations benchmarked

Pricing Recommendation Matrix

Revenue Stream	Recommended move	Number	Impact
All non-dues revenue	Index to inflation	3%/yr (CPI, capped 5%)	Foundational
Member/Non-member	Consistent non-member premium	30-50% premium over member pricing	High
Certification	One time catch up + bundling + CPI	Application \$250→\$275, Exam \$600→\$660, Retake \$300→\$330, Recertification \$200→\$220 (flat +10%), then CPI	High
The Benchmarker	Raise at ERP upgrade + Self-serve upgrade	Tiered multiples 1.5x/2.25x/2.5x/5x/10x to close spread	High
Peer Groups	New Tiers + CPE Premium	\$785 → \$1,050/\$1,360 (already rolling out); + CPE → \$1,050 → \$1,200 / \$1,360 → \$1,550	Medium
Partnerships	Continue Principal Renegotiation	\$175k → \$257k (inflation floor) to \$380k (Elite parity)	High
Education	CPI + widen member vs non-member gap	~3-5%/yr, no catch-up needed	Medium
Conferences	Annual increase + keep the tiered registration	~3-5%/yr, no catch-up needed	Medium

Methodology



Non-Dues Inventory

Catalogued every existing non-dues revenue stream and how each is priced today, the starting map for the whole project.



Peer benchmarking

Started with 10+ associations, narrowed to the 2 to 3 closest peers per segment, plus CFMA's own member sentiment data, used as a reference point, not a template.



Stakeholder Interviews

Customer Experience, Membership, Certification, Product & Data Analytics, and Member Engagement leadership were consulted, gaining price history and context across every non-dues segment and product.



Five-year model

Compiled into three scenarios, conservative, base, and optimistic, that can be toggled, and the rest auto-populates.

Three pricing gaps that repeat across every segment



Frozen pricing

Certification unchanged 6 to 7 years. Peer Group pricing, until recently, did not even cover its own facilitation cost.



No inflation indexing

Membership dues rise with CPI every year. Non-dues pricing is repriced by hand, only when someone happens to revisit it.



Inconsistent member vs non-member pricing

No organization-wide policy. Gaps run from about \$250 to nothing at all in some products, we're recommending a consistent 30-50% non-member premium to close it.

Members show minimal price sensitivity

88%

Member satisfaction (CSAT)
FYE2026 Membership Survey

60

Net Promoter Score, versus an
industry average of 32

60%

Of education attendees have their
costs covered by employers

3 for 3

Every recent price increase CFMA
has made Peer Groups (last two
annual increases) and Conferences
(6% this year) has drawn zero
documented member pushback

Product

WORST CASE

\$339k

FY29 Revenue · -2.9% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$101k

Why: Tiered restructuring slips again. Benchmarker gets only routine inflation while State Tax Guide and The Book keep declining as planned.

BASE CASE

\$382k

FY29 Revenue · 3.0% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$143k

Why: Benchmarker restructuring partially lands. Managed decline continues elsewhere on its current trajectory.

BEST CASE

\$447k

FY29 Revenue · 11.5% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$209k

Why: Tiered multiples (1.5x to 10x) go live, closing the \$12,000 to \$55,000 B2B and B2C gap, aided by new ERP-partnership data.

Certification

WORST CASE

\$718k

FY29 Revenue · 0.7% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$346k

Why: The fee-structure review stalls and the paused CPI-based schedule stays paused.

BASE CASE

\$817k

FY29 Revenue · 7.4% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$445k

Why: The proposed glide path (\$200 to \$220) lands, paired with a pay-\$600-upfront lock-in option for new cohorts.

BEST CASE

\$906k

FY29 Revenue · 13.2% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$534k

Why: Faster catch-up on the multi-year freeze, plus bundling that lifts spend per candidate without a sticker increase.

Conferences

WORST CASE

\$4.20m

FY29 Revenue · 0.7% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$155k

Why: Revenue growth stalls while expenses keep climbing about 5% a year. Net contribution falls 67% in two years and is on track to turn into a loss the year after.

BASE CASE

\$4.61m

FY29 Revenue · 5.4% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$557k

Why: Steady registration increases continue alongside the Principal-tier sponsorship renegotiation.

BEST CASE

\$5.00m

FY29 Revenue · 9.8% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$954k

Why: Registration grows up to 9% a year and the Principal, Elite, and Strategic renegotiation lands broadly.

Chapter Engagement

WORST CASE

\$636k

FY29 Revenue · 1.9% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): (\$1.16m)

Why: Only routine Strategic-tier creep, while three-year Principal and Elite contracts stay locked in place.

BASE CASE

\$700k

FY29 Revenue · 6.9% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): (\$1.10m)

Why: New Peer Group tiers (\$1,050 or \$1,360) phase in as the program shifts to a calendar-year cycle.

BEST CASE

\$808k

FY29 Revenue · 14.8% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): (\$992k)

Why: Principal renegotiation lands broadly and a premium third Peer Group tier launches. Still short of breakeven by design.

Education

WORST CASE

\$1.35m

FY29 Revenue · -2.4% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$357k

Why: Foundational-topic saturation wins out across Live Online, On-Demand, and Certificate offerings.

BASE CASE

\$1.56m

FY29 Revenue · 5.1% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$571k

Why: Validated, modality-specific growth continues as the needs assessment confirms current course demand.

BEST CASE

\$1.84m

FY29 Revenue · 14.2% CAGR

Net contribution (FY29): \$853k

Why: The needs assessment unlocks high-demand topics; new certificate programs and the cohort pilot scale.



Bundling Strategy:

1. CCIFP Pathway Bundle

- Application fee + exam fee + one retake + study guide + prep.
- \$1,950 separately and \$1,750 bundled.
- Why: removes "nickel and dimed" feeling from itemized fees.

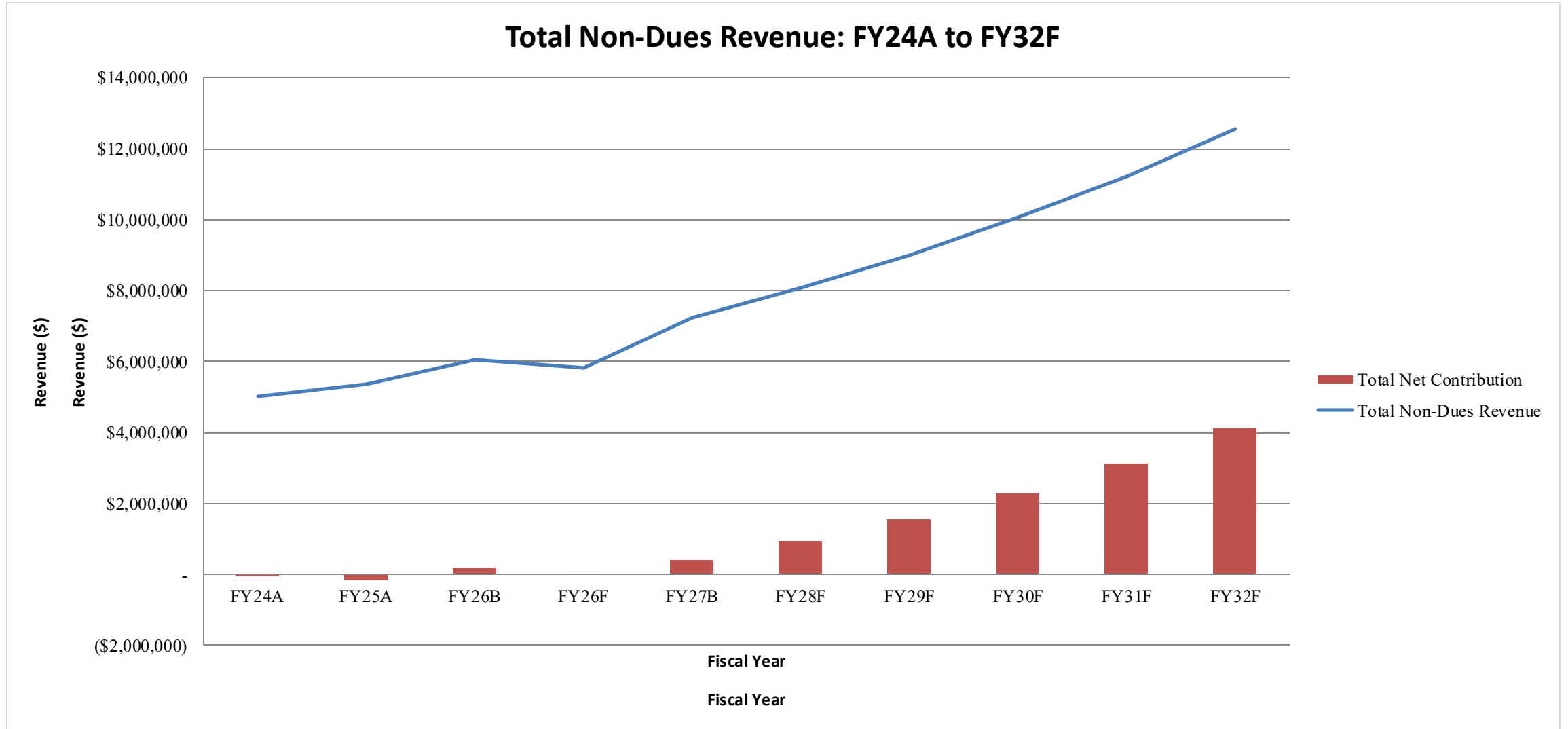
2. Peer Groups + CPE

- Add CPE credit to in person meetings.
- 1st meeting: \$1,050 to \$1,200.
- 2nd meeting: \$1,360 to \$1,550.
- Why: CPE raises the value and justifies a higher price.

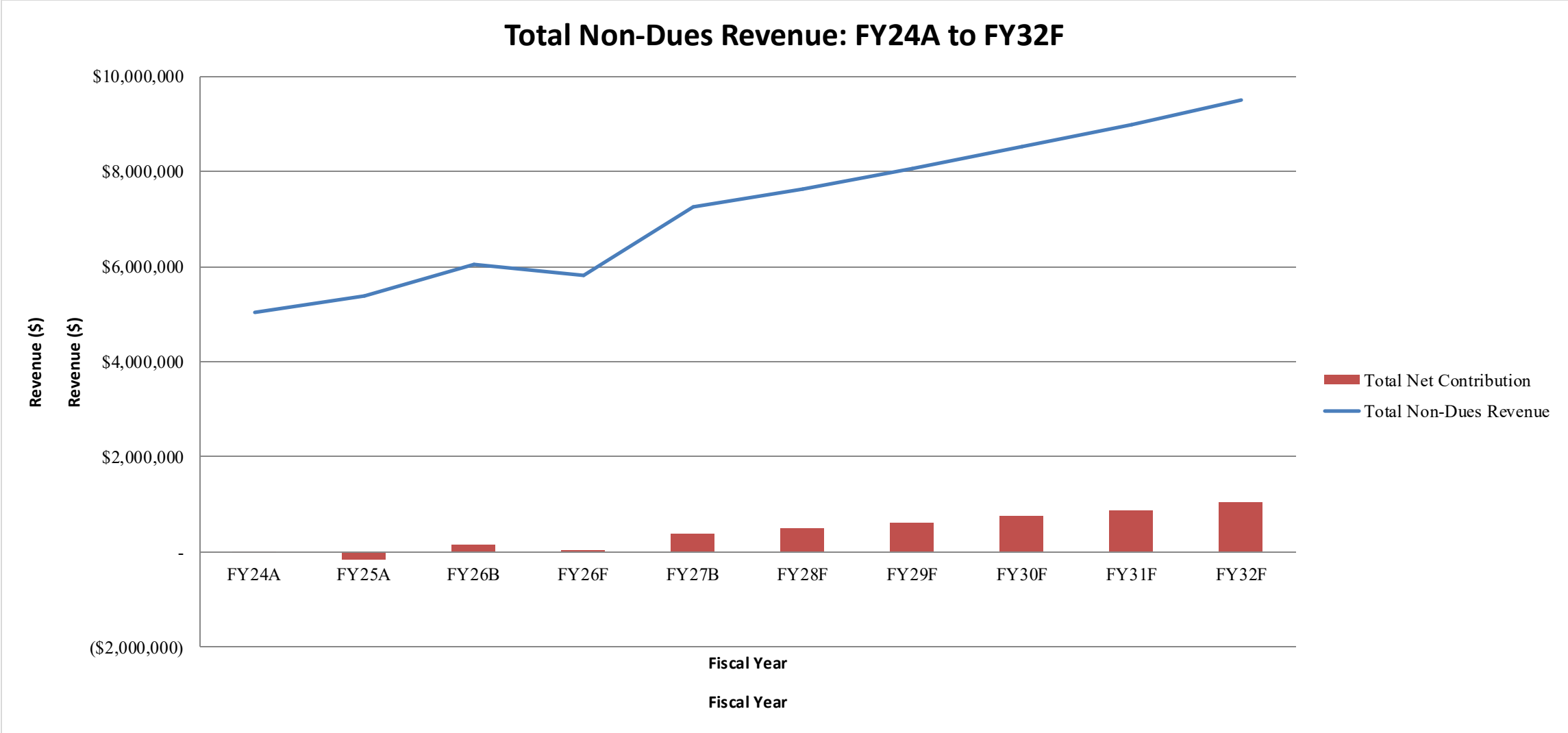
3. The Benchmarker Upgrade

- Self-serve upgrade from pdf/excel to full subscription.
- Charge the price difference.
- Why: removes manual invoice friction.

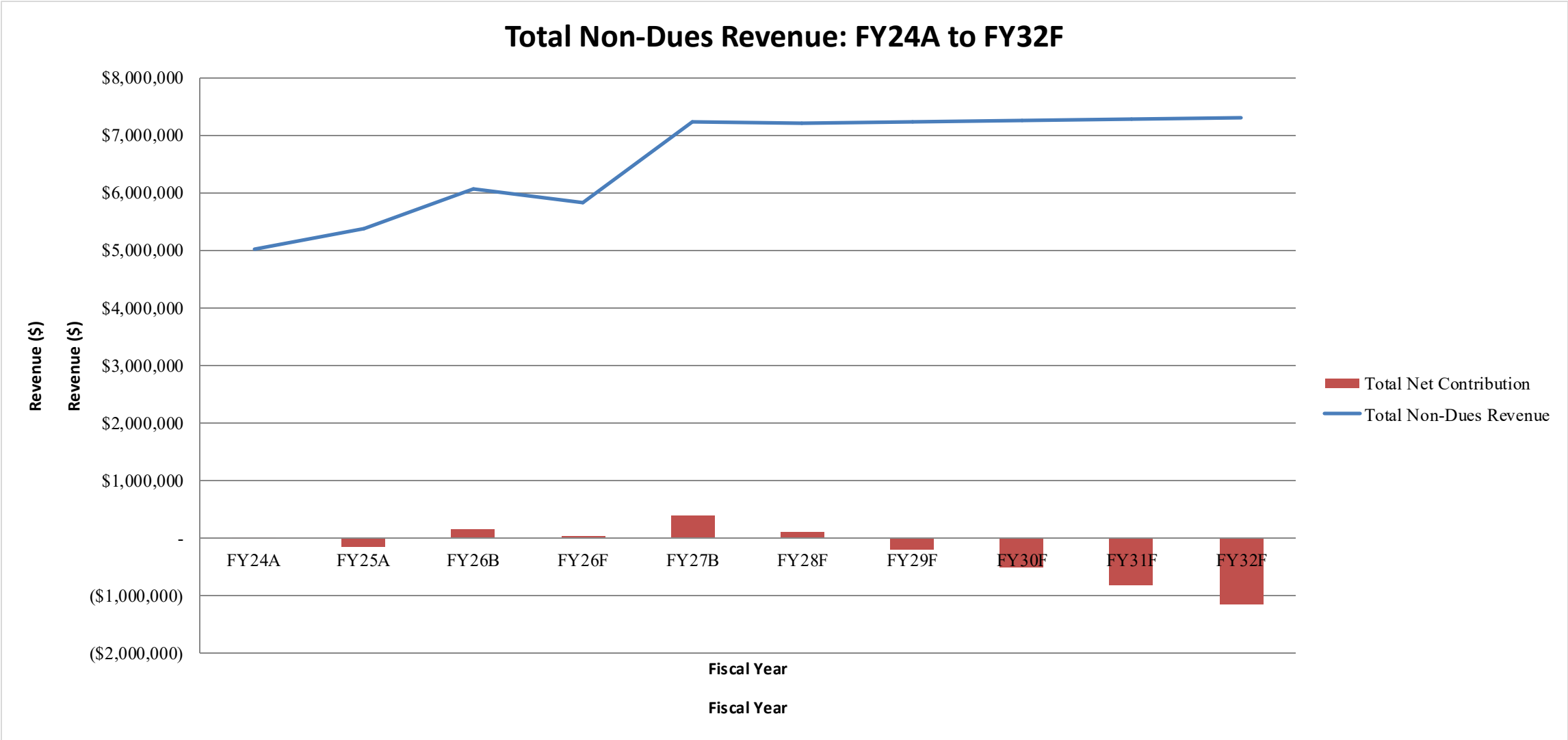
Best Case



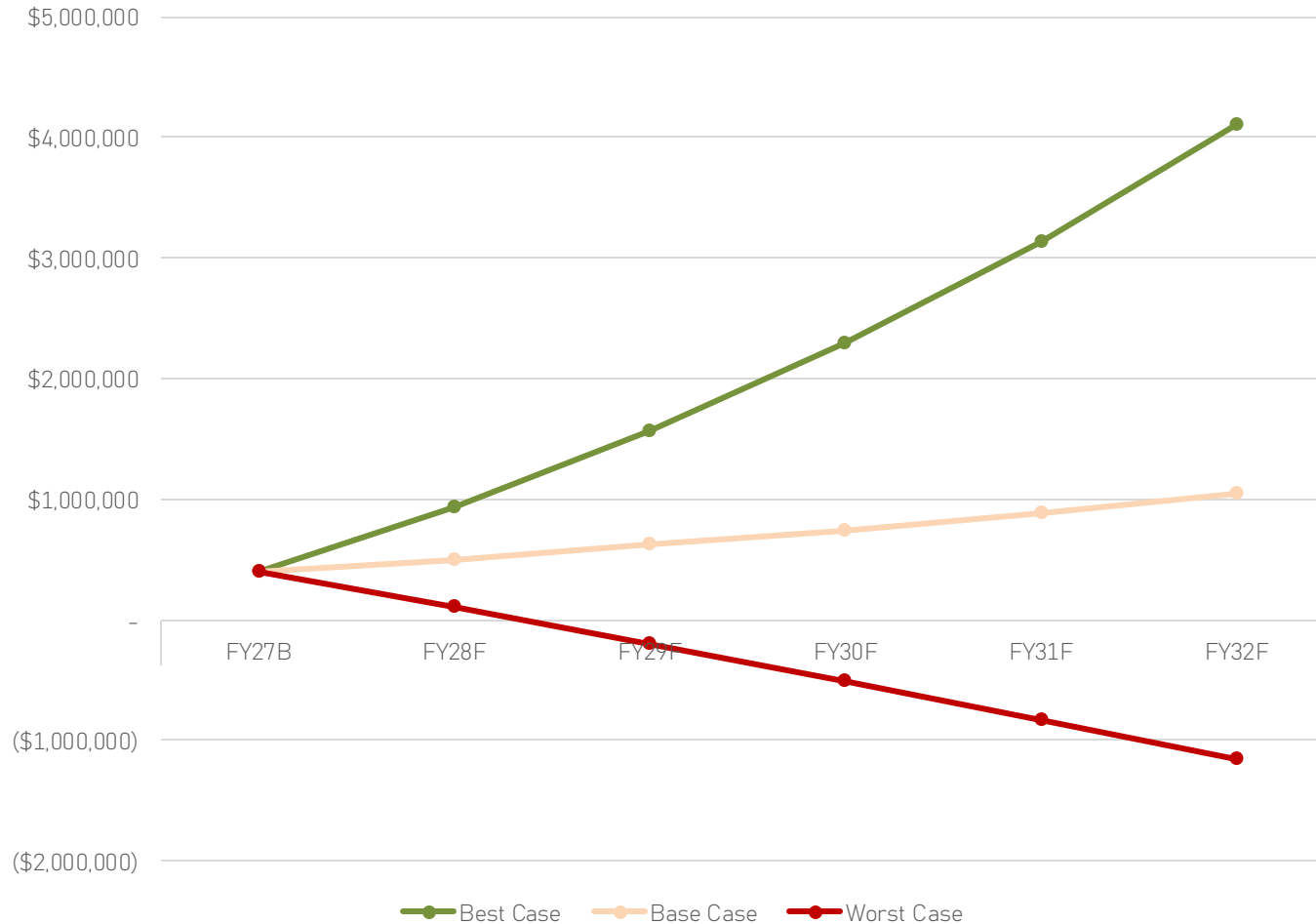
Base Case



Worst Case



Financial Outlook



- Best case: this report's recommendations land broadly across all five segments.
- Base case: current, already-budgeted pricing discipline, no new recommendations.
- Worst case: turns negative in FY29 and keeps declining. Costs outrun frozen pricing.

Implementation Road Map



Already in motion

Forvis Mazars Principal partnership renegotiation.

Annual conference registration increase, applied each January.

Peer Group tiered pricing and shift to a calendar-year cycle, effective January 2027.



FY28: structural changes

Financial Benchmarker tiered pricing, timed to the ERP data rollout.

Certification fee-structure review and bundle design.

Education bundling of the CCIFP Study Guide and certificate content.



FY28 planning decisions

Organization-wide member versus non-member pricing policy.

Peer Group third tier evaluation (longer in-person meetings, CPE-eligible, no virtual calls).



Ongoing

Annual CPI-based repricing across all non-dues lines.

Recurring partnership tier review so Principal, Elite, and Strategic pricing doesn't drift out of line again.

Peer benchmarking refresh every six months.

Wrapping Up

CFMA has the loyalty. Pricing is yet to catch up:

- By FY29, non-dues net contribution ranges from a \$205k loss if pricing stalls, to \$616k on the current path to \$1.56m if these recommendations are implemented and land.
- The scenarios in this presentation are not a forecast. They are a map of what options are available to CFMA if it acts on what its own data and members are already saying.



Thank you

Time for Questions and Discussion

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Full detail: Strategic Pricing Final Report · Pricing Recommendation Matrix